

Closing the Interview

Estimated time needed: 3 minutes

Introduction

Closing the interview is your final opportunity to leave an impression on the interviewer that improves your chances of moving to the next round or getting a job offer. Therefore, you must close the interview on a strong note and leave a good impression that sets you apart from the other candidates.

Objectives

After completing this reading, you will be able to describe key points to address when closing an interview.

Closing the interview: Guidance

Closing an interview is a final opportunity to answer any questions, express interest in the position, sell yourself one last time, discuss the next steps in the hiring process, and leave a lasting impression.

Here is some guidance on how to close an interview.

Express your interest in the position

Ensure the interviewer knows you are interested in the position and becoming part of the company. This can be accomplished by thanking them for their time and expressing your appreciation for the opportunity to interview. Stand up, shake hands, and provide that one final smile before you leave the room.

Ask questions

Asking questions is an important step in the interview process and an opportunity for you. Recall some of the questions we recommended you consider in prior readings and videos. Asking thoughtful questions can help you stand out from other candidates. In addition, they show that you are genuinely interested in the position. As a review, you can ask about the company culture, the team you will be working with, or any other relevant topics.

Address any concerns

There may be parts of the interview you believe did not go as well as expected. Address these areas, ask for constructive feedback, or provide additional clarification now that you've had some time to reflect. This can help alleviate any concerns the interviewer may have had and shows you are adaptable and willing to accept critical feedback to learn and grow.

Reiterate your qualifications

There is a communications quote. "Tell them what you'll tell them, tell them, and tell them what you told them." It is a best practice to reiterate key areas of your skills and experience that make you a good fit for the position. This helps to reinforce your candidacy, and potentially leave a lasting impression, and improve your chances of receiving an offer.

Have a final closing statement

For example, "I am confident that my skills and experience make me the right candidate for the job, and I look forward to hearing from you soon."

Thank the interviewer

End the interview by thanking the interviewer for their time and consideration. This is a polite way to close the conversation and leave a positive impression to supplement the positive first impression you hopefully made earlier in the interview.

Conclusion

Take some time to think about how you can effectively close the interview in a positive manner and plan accordingly. It may be the final step that leads to the job offer.



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